

To: Board of Education
From: Jon Franco, Senior Chief of Operations, Marshall Haskins, Senior Director of Athletics
Cc: Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong, Superintendent
Deborah Kafoury, Chief of Staff
RE: Boys Volleyball
Date: December 3, 2025

Dear Board Members,

We understand that there continues to be a question of why we cannot offer Boys Volleyball at this time. I want to reiterate that this is not a question of us wanting to offer this opportunity to add boys volleyball as an OSAA sanctioned sport. The question is do we have the financial means to support adding a new sport in our current context where we will be reducing our athletic budget by at least $400,000 to help alleviate the $50 million budget shortfall for next year.

Current context necessitates difficult prioritization:

- Current Budget: PIL Athletics operates with an $8 million budget from the general fund, but our true operational cost is $9.5 million, requiring the PIL to fundraise the remaining $1.5 million annually.
- Recent Cuts: Over the last three years, we have had to reduce our budget by nearly $500,000 per year. This has forced us to eliminate:
  - Over 100 coaching positions.
  - The PIL/PPR 2nd Grade Swim Program, which served 1,300 students with water safety and swim instruction.
  - Our MPG athletic supervisor position.
  - Our College Access Program that helped over 50 historically underserved students find collegiate athletic opportunities last year.
- Future Cuts: Due to the district's projected $50 million deficit, we have been asked to reduce $400,000 to our budget next year.
- Impending Expansion: Looking ahead, we also anticipate future requests for sports like Girls' Flag Football, Boys' and Girls' Lacrosse, and Boys' and Girls' Water Polo, which will further strain our limited resources.



As a school district, the PIL has a long-standing practice against allowing individual PPS teams to fundraise for PIL/OSAA sanctioned activities, as this creates inequity across our system.

- Club Sport Status: Last year, Boys' Volleyball operated as a "club sport," similar to Lacrosse, Ski Team, and Water Polo. In this capacity, all expenses were covered by fundraising, and PIL Athletics had no fiscal responsibility or jurisdiction. Boys volleyball can continue as a club sport.
- Sanctioned Status Implications: Now that Boys' Volleyball has been sanctioned by OSAA, it must be treated like any other sanctioned PIL/OSAA sport. This means PPS/PIL is responsible for funding:
    - Coaches, transportation, uniforms, officials, game workers, game security, and program start-up costs.
- Cost to Add Boys' Volleyball:
    - The base cost to create one team at every high school is $280,386 annually.
    - Break down of costs to fund one team at a high school:

      Varsity coach $11,719
      Varsity assistant $7,325
      Transportation $3,500
      Officials $3,120.
      Uniforms $3,090
      Security $1,200
      Game-Meet Management $1,200
      Equipment / start up-$0.00
      Total per school $31,154

Questions that keep coming up:

Will adding boys volleyball impact PPS Title 9 compliance?
Potentially

1. **Proportionality**

If we were to add boys volleyball, we will widen the proportionality gap in our individual school and district demographic participation data between males and females further jeopardizing our ability to be in compliance with Title 9.

2. **Expansion**

Schools or districts must demonstrate efforts to add participation opportunities for girls sports. We are adding a boys sport instead.



If we were to add boys volleyball, we will widen the disparity between boys and girls sports.

Can club teams compete against OSAA affiliated teams?
Yes, but the OSAA sanctioned team would lose a play date as a result.

Can we fundraise for all of our schools to support boys volleyball?
We do not support fundraising to add sports because it is an unstable resource. We do not want to add a sport and have to take it away the following year. For context, the first year would amount to $280,386 and the second year would be twice that much in order to add multiple levels.

Can individual schools be OSAA sanctioned and fundraise to support adding volleyball?
No. As a district we offer programming at all schools, not individual schools.

We don't need everything, can we run a team on the bare minimum?
The bare minimum would be $23,829 per school which removed the assistant coach. However, due to PPS requirements and contractual obligations nothing else can be removed.

What is the difference between Club and OSAA?
OSAA sanctioned sports are competing for a State championship, they play against other OSAA sanctioned teams, and they have to adhere to all OSAA academic and attendance and on-track to graduation requirements. OSAA sanctioned sports have to abide by PPS HR hiring, training and PAT union requirements. Club sports are not required to follow the above mentioned criteria.

Is it true that the number of club teams will be drastically reduced which will mean our boys playing club will have fewer teams to compete against?
There are 297 schools in OSAA and there are 67-71 schools that are considering offering boys volleyball statewide. PPS is part of the 6A classification and there are only 17 schools out of the 51 in the 6A classification that are considering it. Based on this information, we believe there will be enough club teams available for club volleyball competition for PIL schools.

Closure

- We fully support providing as many athletic opportunities as possible, we just cannot do it at this time due to budget constraints.
- Boys' Volleyball can continue as a club sport.